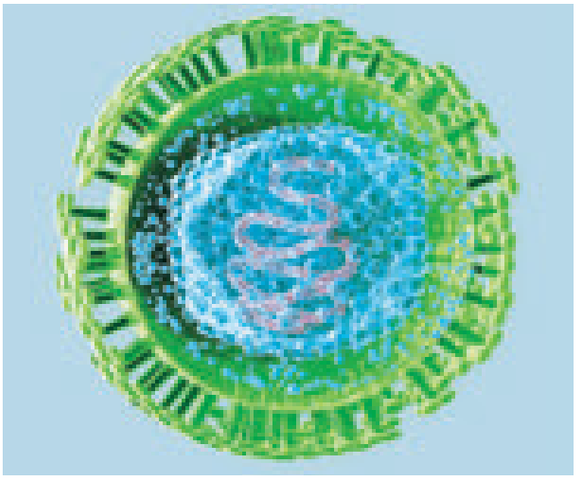


Measles

Definition

Measles is an acute highly infectious disease of childhood caused by a specific virus of the group Myxo viruses.

Causative organism

RNA Para Myxo viruses

Mode of transmission - Droplet infection

Incubation period - 10 days from exposure to onset of fever and 14 days to appearance of rash. Average 7 days.

Clinical manifestations

There are three stages

1. Prodromal stage:

1. Fever
2. Coryza
3. Sneezing
4. Nasal discharge
5. Cough
6. Redness of Eyes
7. Lacrimation
8. Photophobia
9. Vomiting
10. Diarrhea
11. Koplik"S Spots on A Red Base

2. Eruptive phase:

1. Duskyred
2. Macular
3. Maculo-papular rash
4. Rashes become confluent,blotchy

3. Post-measles stage:

1. Weight loss
2. Weakness
3. Growth retardation
4. Reactivation of Pulmonary tuberculosis
5. Nutritional and metabolic effects

Complications

1. Measles – associated diarrhea,
2. Pneumonia
3. Otitis media.
4. Febrile convulsions,
5. Encephalitis
6. Pan-encephalitis.

Control measures

a) Isolation for 7 days after the onset of rash.

b) Immunization of contacts within 2 days of exposure. (if vaccine is contra indicated immunoglobulin should be given within 3 – 4 days of exposure)

c) Prompt immunization at the beginning of an endemic is essential to limit the spread.

Treatment

There is no specific treatment for measles, but the condition usually improves within 7 to 10 days. Following measures are important to control infection.

1. Controlling fever and relieving pain
2. Plenty of fluids to prevent dehydration
3. Treating cold like symptoms
4. Care of the sore eyes - cleaning the crusts with wet cotton swabs.

Measles vaccine: Measles is best prevented by active immunization. The

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